

101 Spread seed hitchhikers

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MINS

Plants spread seeds in many ways. Many “hitchhike” on passing birds, insects, and animals—including humans. After your next nature walk, see what seeds may have come home with you.

What you need

• Metal baking sheet
• Oven mitts • Seed compost • Knife or screwdriver • Plastic wrap • Watering can



1 Preheat the oven to 200°F (100°C). Fill the baking sheet with compost and bake it for 30 minutes to kill any hidden seeds.



2 Remove the sheet from the oven with oven mitts. Let it cool. Use a screwdriver to scrape your shoe soles over the compost.

3 Water the compost with a fine spray. Cover with plastic wrap. Set the tray on a sunny windowsill. Any hitchhiking seeds should sprout in 10 days.

Compost

Shoots grow toward the light

Grass seedling



102 Plant a sock

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Put some old socks over your shoes and take a walk around the yard. Remove the socks, put them in a foil sheet, add compost, and water lightly. See what plants spring up!

Cotton or wool socks are best

